

Stefano Sangiovanni

Ph.D Candidate in Political Science • Milan, Italy

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EDUCATION

NASP Graduate School, University of Milan

Ph.D Candidate in Political Science

October 2023 – Present

Milan, Italy

- Supervisors: Prof. Andrea Ceron, Prof. Giovanna M. Invernizzi
- Thesis Title (Provisional): “The balance between positional and valence issues in party competition”
- Research Interests: Political Parties, Computational Methods, Electoral Behavior, Political Scandals, Quantitative Text Analysis, Survey Experiments

University of Mannheim

Visiting PhD Researcher

May 2025

Mannheim, Germany

- Visiting Fellowship at the Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES)

University of Milan

Master's Degree in Administration and Public Policy, 110/110 with honours

October 2020 – March 2023

Milan, Italy

- Thesis Title: “Communicating in times of crisis: a comparative analysis of school policy discourse in Italy and Great Britain during the covid-19 pandemic”

University of Milan-Bicocca

Bachelor's Degree in Sociology

October 2017 – October 2020

Milan, Italy

- Thesis Title: “Gender Representations in the Media: The Model of the Global Media Monitoring Project”

SUMMER, WINTER SCHOOLS & ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Adapters: Lightweight Machine Learning for Social Science Research, GESIS

Adapter-based fine-tuning of LLMs in Python

June 2025

Large Language Models for Political Scientists, SISP 2024

Gained hands-on experience with LLMs for political science research using Python

September 2024

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), University of Bologna

2-weeks summer school on computational methods, with competitive selection process

June 2024

RECSM Winter Methods School, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Network Analysis and Visualization with R

March 2023

RECSM Summer Methods School, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Introduction to Python, Introduction to R, Survey Methodology and Survey Design

June 2022

TEACHING & TUTORING

Guest Lectures

Political Sociology

BA in International Sciences and European Institutions, University of Milan

Course taught by Prof. Cristiano Vezzoni

Lecture: “Measuring Democracy: Theory and Practice” – [Lecture slides](#)

2023 – 2024

Politics, Philosophy and Public Affairs

Thesis Seminars for Master's students, University of Milan

Lecture: “How to plan a social sciences research design” – [Lecture slides](#)

Lecture: “Introduction to Qualitative Research” – [Lecture slides](#)

2024

Academic Tutoring & Teaching Assistant

Master's Degree Course in Politics, Philosophy and Public Affairs

University of Milan, Italy

January 2024 – October 2024

Bachelor's Degree Course in Political Science

University of Milan, Italy

September 2023 – Present

PUBLICATIONS, CONFERENCES & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Conferences & Seminar Presentations

- 2025 BAGSS Workshop "Computational Text Analysis in Party Research."** *Economic Performance Indicators and Strategic Valence Choices*. University of Bamberg, 25–26 September 2025.
- 2025 Social Science Methodology Conference (RC33).** *Generational Perspectives on Democracy: Migrants' Satisfaction Across National and European Levels*. University of Naples, 22–25 September 2025 (with G. Celebrin).
- 2025 Italian Political Science Association (SISP).** University of Naples, 4–6 September 2025.
- 2025 MetRiSP Workshop.** *Methods for Political Science Research in the Age of Artificial Intelligence*. MetRiSP Network, 3 September 2025.
- 2025 Collegio Carlo Alberto Days.** *When Valence Strategies Increase Polling Support: Evidence from Electoral Campaigns*. Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin.
- 2025 MZES-DVPW Methods of Political Science.** *Investigating Political Scandals: Combining Conjoint Analysis and Audio-Based Experiments*. University of Mannheim (with A. Ceron & G. M. Invernizzi).
- 2024 POLS PIRSS Seminar Series.** *Analyzing Public Perceptions of Government Actions and Political Scandals Through Survey Experimental Designs*. University of Milan (with U. Platini).
- 2024 Italian Political Science Association (SISP).** University of Trieste, 12–14 September 2024.
- 2024 Collegio Carlo Alberto Days.** *Valence Theory and Political Scandals: A Proposal of a Conjoint Experiment*. Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin.
- 2022 Jean Monnet Centres of Excellence.** *European Emission Trading System: The Impact of EU-ETS on Costs and Benefits*. University of Milan (with A. Lombardi, M. Nascone & E. Rossoni).

Working Papers

- Sangiovanni, S., Ceron, A., Invernizzi, G.** "Investigating Political Scandals: Combining Conjoint Analysis and Audio-Based Experiments"
- Sangiovanni, S.** "When Valence Strategies Increase Polling Support: Evidence from Electoral Campaigns"
- Sangiovanni, S.** "Economic Performance Indicators and Strategic Valence Choices"
- Celebrin, G., **Sangiovanni, S.** "Generational Perspectives on Democracy: Migrants' Satisfaction Across National and European Levels"
- Holdrich, E., **Sangiovanni, S., Végh, M.** "Analyzing Hungarian Parliamentary Debates with ManifestoBERTa"
- Sangiovanni, S.** "Feeding the Cycle of Negativity: Exploring the Media's Influence on the Tone of Electoral Campaigns"

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Academic

- Conference Organization Team Member** September 2023
ESPAnet 2023, University of Milan, Italy
Managed logistics for conference sessions and collaborated with colleagues in supervising students responsible for assisting conference attendees. Contributed to the preparation of conference materials and documentation
- Research Assistant** October 2020 – December 2020
Global Media Monitoring Project, University of Milan-Bicocca, Italy
Collected and analyzed tweets from 7 Italian newspapers as part of the Global Media Monitoring Project, in collaboration with the Milano-Bicocca University research group. [Read the italian GMMP 2020 Report](#)
- Tutoring Online Project** October 2022 – March 2023
Bocconi University - Harvard University, Milan, Italy
Delivered over 40 hours of tutorship in Mathematics, English, and Italian to support students with financial and learning difficulties

Extra-Academic

- Esports Caster – Content Creator** September 2014 – May 2018
Spaziogames, Milan, Italy
Created content and managed live streaming events via OBS Studio, provided live commentary for esports tournaments with over 10k concurrent viewers and wrote articles and reviews for the website

AWARDS, GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- 2025** Visiting PhD Fellowship, Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES)
- 2025** MetRiSP Workshop Travel Grant, awarded by SISP, GPR, and ECPR’s Standing Group on Political Methodology
- 2025** MZES-DVPW Conference Travel Grant for Early-Career Researchers, awarded by MZES
- 2023** Doctoral Scholarship. Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan

SKILLS

Languages	English (IELTS Academic Band 8, C1), Italian (native), Spanish (A2)
Programming Languages	R, Python, L ^A T _E X, SQL
Data Analysis Tools	STATA, Tableau, SPSS
Developer Tools	Git, GitHub, VisualStudio Code, Jupyter Notebook
Live Streaming Tools	OBS Studio, OBS Ninja, StreamElements
GIS Tools	QGIS